Nikos Kougianos

Java Team Lead

nkougian@outlook.com | Athens, Greece | Greek, English

kougianos.com | github.com/kougianos | linkedin.com/in/kougianos

Java enthusiast with a B.Sc. in Computer Science and a M.Sc. in Data Science, bringing over 8 years of professional experience in software development. For the past 4 years, I have gained deep expertise in the iGaming industry and microservice-based architectures, specializing in creating scalable, efficient applications that drive organizational success.

EXPERIENCE

Java team lead - Full time Contract — April 2025 – Present

Playnetic (Casino Dpt.) — *United Kingdom (Remote)*

- Led a team of 5 developers, collaborating directly with Directors, Product, and C-level management to translate high-level business goals into technical requirements and actionable sprint tasks.
- Maintained the core slot engine and developed game simulation logic to mathematically guarantee and verify the Return to Player (RTP) percentages across the games portfolio.
- Engineered dynamic slot mechanics and engagement features, successfully integrating high-performing concepts including Power Bet, Feature Buy, and Free Spins configurations into production games.
- Delivered backend infrastructure for heavily regulated markets, implementing real-time winnings reporting, live jackpot contribution tracking, and automated end-of-day (EoD) financial reporting.
- Extended and maintained high-performance core Remote Gaming Server (RGS) services, ensuring ultra-low latency, strict fault tolerance, and seamless support for third-party integrations and back-office systems.
- Implemented automated session finalization logic to handle incomplete or abandoned rounds, ensuring durable state persistence and strict compliance with regulated market standards (MGA, Italy, and Greece).
- Extended the RGS contract/API architecture to support advanced regulatory payload flags, enabling robust server-side enforcement of Reality Check, Ultra Turbo Spin, and Autoplay restrictions.

Stack:
Java 25, Spring Boot 3, Apache Kafka, Redis, Cassandra DB, PostgreSQL, Svelte/Typescript

Senior Software Engineer (Java) - Full time contract — August 2022 – April 2025

BVGroup (Gaming/Casino Dpt.) — *Gibraltar (Remote)*

- Enhanced an internal marketing tool, resulting in a 30% performance improvement and seamless integration with future 3rd party APIs.
- Streamlined promotions tool by refactoring the frontend and backend, consolidating integrations into a unified UI and introducing a simplified UI to operators.
- Developed and maintained microservices for seamless integration with 3rd party game providers, ensuring fault tolerance during authentication, game launches and transactions.
- Implemented a reactive, non-blocking architecture for efficient communication between microservices, optimizing performance and enabling scalable growth. Utilized Apache Kafka and Spring Reactive libraries.

Stack:
Java 21, Spring Boot 3, Apache Kafka, Redis, MongoDB, Spring Reactive, Junit5, Testcontainers, GCP, Typescript/Angular

Lead Engineer (Java) - 3-month contract — July 2024 – September 2024

Khantech (Casino & Sportsbook) — *Dubai (Remote)*

- Architected and developed the core wallet service and critical backend systems, including transaction history, player history, session management (Redis), and a comprehensive Casino API for seamless integration with the frontend.
- Led end-to-end integrations with TimelessTech for casino operations and Betby for sportsbook functionalities, enabling efficient game launches and real-time transaction handling.
- Implemented an event-driven architecture using Apache Kafka to support scalable, asynchronous communication across microservices.

Stack:
Java 21, Spring Boot 3, Apache Kafka, Redis, MongoDB, Spring Reactive (Webflux), Kubernetes

Software Engineer (Java) - Full time — January 2022 – August 2022

Atos — *Athens, Greece (Remote)*

- Worked on a microservice-based Healthcare Interoperability application, delivered to various clients from the health industry.
- Introduced an asynchronous multithreaded approach for database lookups by using Spring's built-in functionalities, improving response times by over 40%.
- Implemented a Role Based Access Control mechanism using Spring Security and token generation/authentication.

Stack:
Java 17, Spring Boot, Maven, Microsoft Azure, PostgreSQL, Junit, RestAssured, HAPI-FHIR (server & java client), Typescript/Angular

Software Engineer (Java) - Full time — July 2019 - January 2022

OTE-COSMOTE — *Athens, Greece*

- Designed and developed Communication Hub, an internal group of microservices responsible for transmitting over 1 million SMS/Emails/Push Notifications to end users on a daily basis.
- Implemented scalable integration microservices assisting in the interconnection of different end systems inside the organization.
- Participated in the first agile team created to lead the Agile Transformation initiative in the company.

Stack:
Java 11, Spring Boot, Maven, Kubernetes, Jenkins, MongoDB, Apache Kafka, Junit, Kibana, Grafana

Full Stack Engineer (PHP) - Full time — November 2018 - May 2019

Figame LTD — *Athens, Greece*

- Developed against Expedia and Booking APIs to integrate new services and features into figame.gr and affiliate websites.
- Introduced a parallel search solution for flight tickets that improved overall user experience and reduced total response times by over 80%, using PHP MultiCurl.

Stack:
PHP 7, Bootstrap 4, jQuery, MongoDB, MySQL, SVN, Bash

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Data Science - 8.5/10 — 2019 - 2021

University of East London

• **Courses:** Data Ecology, Quantitative Data Analysis, Spatial Data Analysis, Advanced Decision Making
• **Thesis:** "Application development for supervised and unsupervised machine learning, utilized on a dataset of building energy features recording."

Stack:
R, Python 3, MongoDB, ML Libraries (pandas, sklearn, matplotlib)

B.Sc. Computer Science - 6.9/10 — 2011 - 2018

National and Kapodistrian University of Athens - Dpt. of Informatics and Telecommunication

Thesis: Airbnb clone (Java, MySQL)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Backend:** Java 11+, Spring (Boot, Security, Data), Python
- **Frontend:** Angular, Typecript, Material, JQuery
- **CI/CD/Cloud:** Docker, Kubernetes, Google Cloud, Azure, AWS
- **Persistence:** MongoDB, Redis, CassandraDB, PostgreSQL
- **Other:** Spring Reactive, Apache Kafka, Jupyter notebooks, Python ML Libraries, Spring Unit/Integration testing, REST, GraphQL, SOAP